

net and Entertainment menus that can be accessed using the Magic Bright button on the front panel. There is also the Highlight button that ensures clear images on the screen while video-conferencing, by highlighting areas that emphasise the overall clarity of the picture. The OSD is very easy to use and is well-complemented by seven buttons that make browsing through the menu a breeze. It bundles an exhaustive user's manual and a quick-start guide, along with the driver CDs and colour profiling software. For added functionality, you have an optional USB hub and multimedia speaker stand thrown in.

The LG Studioworks 700S was the lightest monitor that we received. The factor that differentiates it from the LG Flatron E 700S is the much-appreciated fully flat tube. The MV7500 17-inch monitor from Compaq was the best looking monitor in the comparison test. With a dual tone paint finish—a gorgeous opal front bezel and a black carbon finish—this monitor has the edge when it comes to aesthetic appeal. Its OSD menu is icon-based, with just three buttons for configuring the various parameters of the monitor. The slightly large blue power button lends a good character to the otherwise plain front panel. It has a conventional FST (Flat Square Technology) picture tube with no anti-glare or anti-static coating, which is the only chink in its armour. The monitor comes with detachable JBL platinum speakers, a colour management software and all the other necessary cables and guides.

19-inch monitors

The BenQ V991 comes in a white body shell, and is complimented by four easy-to-use blue buttons and a large prominent power switch on the front panel. The highlight of this monitor is the resolution, which can go up to 1600 x 1200 at 78 Hz. The monitor comes with an anti-glare and anti-reflective coating, making it a sight

that won't cause sore eyes.

This monitor was quite a performer, battling to the top of almost every test we threw at it. Its results in the geometry and the sharpness and resolution tests were especially good, making it stand out among the crowd. The only downside was that the entire package had no extra additions, such as USB hubs or speakers—which could have provided value added enhancements for the monitor, in the absence of a full flat picture tube.

The 955DF comes from the Samsung's professional monitor series which claims to be feature-rich, and at the same time, performs to the brim. This monitor, based on Samsung's Dyna Flat technology was one of the fully flat 19-inch monitors that we received. The monitor is well designed, moulded to hide bulk of the 19-inch monitor. The front panel is home to nothing but the power switch; all the other controls are hidden by a pop-open flap panel. Despite such entrappings, the buttons were unobtrusive and easily accessible.

The 900B from LG belongs to the standard revamped Studioworks series and hence, does not offer a full flat picture tube. It is designed to be practical, with a six-button, easy-to-use OSD menu. The monitor is capable of displaying a resolution of 1600 x 1200, but at a respectable frequency of 75 Hz. It is a good buy for its price of Rs 14,990, and has the usual cables, guides and warranty card.

NEC's MultiSync 95 sports the usual monstrous looks of a 19-inch monitor with a contemporary design that lacks aesthetic appeal. The monitor has a decent OSD menu that can be accessed through the three buttons provided on the front panel. A commendable aspect of the MultiSync 95 is the excellent resolution at which it can be operated—it is capable of displaying a resolution of 1600 x 1200 without any flicker. It comes bundled with the usual stuff such as users manual, colour profile

The evolution of display technology



1897: First CRT scanning

device constructed by German scientist, Karl Ferdinand Braun

1905: Nipkow disc and CRT is demonstrated

1923: Zworykin patents the Iconoscope pickup tube for television. The complete TV system, including kinescope, or picture tube is demonstrated

1950: Ben Laposky uses oscilloscope to display waveforms that were photographed as artwork



1963: George H Heilmeyer and Richard Williams publish a report suggesting the use of liquid crystal materials for display

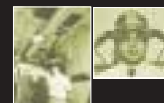
1964: IBM 2250 console worth \$125,000 is introduced with the IBM 360 computer



1965: Tektronix Direct View Storage Tube (DVST) is introduced



1968: The Tektronix 4010 is released



1968: Sutherland Head Mounted Display (Sword of Damocles), developed in 1966, is shown

1971: An improved Liquid Crystal Display is invented by James Fergason

1971: The first 'touch sensor' is developed by Dr Sam Hurst

1979: IBM 3279 colour terminal introduced

1981: IBM introduces 4-colour monitor

1987: VGA (Video Graphics Array) invented by IBM



BenQ G774

- + High refresh rates
- Heavy



Compaq MV 7500

- + Good overall performance; includes external speaker set
- No antiglare coating; expensive



HCL HCM780M

- + Economically priced
- Poor performance overall



HCL HCM785 RFM

- + F&FST; fine dot pitch
- No antiglare coating



LG Flatron E700S

- + F&FST
- Poor performance in the Geometry test